

Lorenz Gschwent

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Research interests

Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Innovation

References

Tobias Seidel	Martin Karlsson	Philip Jung
University of Duisburg-Essen	University of Duisburg-Essen	TU Dortmund University
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Education

PhD in Economics	2022 - 2027 (expected)
University of Duisburg-Essen, RTG Regional Disparities and Economic Policy Supervisor: Tobias Seidel	
Master of Science in Economics	2019 - 2021
University of Vienna, Academic track	
Erasmus Semester	September 2020 - January 2021
Aix-Marseille School of Economics, “Econometrics, Big Data, Statistics” track	
Bachelor of Science in Economics	2015 - 2019
University of Vienna	
Bakkalaureat of Philosophy in Communication Science	2014 - 2018
University of Vienna	

Current projects

“Selection in the Patent Lottery”. Job Market Paper.
Abstract: The patent lottery created by inconsistent examination at the US Patent and Trademark Office is well documented, but the kind of patents it creates is unknown. Using the lottery’s quasi-random variation, I characterize marginal patents in 5.4 million applications across invention quality and filed scope of exclusionary rights. I find that inconsistency creates overly broad patents. At every level of invention quality, applicants select into the lottery through the broadness of the scope they file. On average, a patent at the top of the filed scope distribution is 40% more likely to owe its grant to a lenient examiner than

a patent at the bottom. In a structural model of patent examination, a consistent examiner pool reallocates 11.7% of granted scope – and almost all of the reallocation is between applications of the same quality.

“Censorship in Democracy”. With Marcel Caesmann and Matteo Grigoletto. [Working Paper](#). (Submitted).

Abstract: Democracies increasingly use censorship to counter foreign propaganda, yet evidence on its consequences remains scarce. We exploit the European Union’s 2022 ban on Russia Today (RT) and Sputnik as a natural experiment, using a triple-difference design that compares users connected to the banned outlets against unconnected users in EU and non-EU countries. We analyze a daily panel of 677,780 tweets from 146,633 Twitter users in seven European countries. Pro-Russia output declines by 21.7% among connected EU users; in a difference-in-differences comparison with non-EU users, total pro-Russia output among EU users falls by 13.6%. Alternative suppliers do not fill the gap: neither their pro-Russia output nor the engagement they receive rises after the ban. Consistent with an agenda-setting role of the banned outlets, the share of EU users’ tweets covering the outlets’ daily top-five topics decreases by 17%. A survey experiment offers suggestive evidence that such censorship can come at a cost to the very norms it is meant to defend.

Publications

“The Rise of Health Economics: Transforming the Landscape of Economic Research”. With Björn Hammarfelt, Martin Karlsson, and Mathias Kifmann. [Health Economics](#).

Abstract: This paper explores the evolving role of health economics within economic research and publishing over the past 30 years. Historically, largely a niche field, health economics has become increasingly prominent, with the share of health economics papers in top journals growing significantly. We aim to identify the factors behind this rise. Using a combination of bibliometric methods and natural language processing, we classify abstracts to define health economics. Adapting Kelly et al.’s (2021) method to evaluate the novelty, impact, and quality of academic papers, we demonstrate that the mainstreaming of health economics is driven by innovative, high-quality research, with two notable waves in quality ratings that highlights the emergence and impact of distinct subfields within the discipline. We find a strong positive correlation between citations and quality ratings, with health economics papers receiving fewer citations for their quality compared to other economics fields. Pandemic-related research received a high number of citations during 2020 and 2021; however, our findings indicate that this work was not systematically more novel or impactful than prior studies within the same subfield.

Presentations

2026: DRUID Academy, ZEW PRICE Seminar, ICSSI Boulder, Melbourne Institute, University of Melbourne

2025: 18th RGS Doctoral Conference, 2nd Duke Strategy PhD Conference, BSE Summer Forum (Economics of Science and Innovation), REGIS Summer School, EPIP Annual Conference, 8th RISE Workshop

2024: 7th Conference on the Political Economy of Democracy and Dictatorship, 17th RGS Doctoral Conference

2023: CINCH Research Agenda for Ukraine Workshop (online), 5th Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop (online), NOeG (Annual Conference of the Austrian Economic Association), Digital Democracy Workshop DigDemLab, 17th CESifo Workshop on Political Economy, 2nd CESifo/ifo Junior Workshop on Big Data

Other publications (pre-PhD)

[Digital Tasks and ICT Capital: Methodologies and Data](#) (with Dario Guarascio, Stefan Jestl, Alireza Sabouniha, and Roman Stöllinger), wiiw Statistical Report No. 11, January 2023

Teaching

Teaching Assistant: Introductory Econometrics (BA; yearly, since summer term 2023), Econometrics II (PhD; summer term 2026), Introductory Microeconomics (BA; winter term 2026)

Supervision: Bachelor Seminar in Economics (since winter term 2022/'23), Master Seminar Applied Economic Research (summer term 2023), bachelor theses (5+ total)

Visiting

Melbourne Institute
ZEW Mannheim

September-November 2026
February/March 2026

Previous positions

Research Associate

October 2021 - August 2022

Wyss Academy for Nature at the University of Bern

Pre-Doctoral Research Assistant with Kai Gehring

Part-time Research Assistant

July 2021 - September 2021

The Vienna Institute for International Economic Studies (wiiw)

Awards

EPIP Young Scholar Award 2025 for “Selection in the Patent Lottery”

SSES Young Economist Award 2025, NOeG Young Economist Award 2023 for “Censorship in Democracy”

Languages

German (native), English